FERNANDO COSTA XAVIER

Finance & Controllership Executive | LATAM Multi-Entity Operations | IFRS • US GAAP • BR GAAP

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Finance & Controllership Director with 10+ years leading GL accounting, financial reporting, and compliance for multinational groups across multiple LATAM countries. Expert in IFRS, US GAAP, and BR GAAP with proven success automating 70% of manual processes and reducing close cycles by 40%. Experienced in building financial operations from the ground up in regulated, cross-border environments. CRC-certified, trilingual (Portuguese, English C2, Spanish C1).

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Automated 70%+ of manual GL accounting and reconciliation tasks through the 'Integrated Accounting Intelligence' initiative, reducing month-end close cycle by 40% and improving data quality across 5 LATAM entities.
- Owned end-to-end GL accounting and financial reporting for subsidiaries in 5 countries (Brazil, Mexico, Chile, Argentina, Peru), ensuring audit readiness and compliant reporting under IFRS, US GAAP, and local standards.
- Led 3 M&A due diligence and post-merger integration projects, standing up new-entity statutory accounting, internal controls, and local compliance frameworks from scratch.
- Developed PMO governance and internal finance academy, recognised by global headquarters for leadership during hyperinflation and tax reform challenges in Argentina and Brazil.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Chief Accounting & Finance Director

*Forvis Mazars | São Paulo, Brazil*May 2025 – Present

- Set strategic vision for GL accounting and finance functions, partnering with CFOs, auditors, and boards to align operations with corporate strategy across multiple business units.
- Drive digital transformation and AI adoption using SAP, Power BI, ClickUp, and Microsoft GPT, enabling continuous improvement in financial close and reporting processes.
- Lead FP&A, budgeting, forecasting, and cost optimisation; support M&A due diligence, valuation, and post-merger integration.
- Ensure compliance with IFRS, US GAAP, BR GAAP, and regulatory bodies; design internal controls framework and manage audit readiness.

Regional Controller LATAM & Head of Statutory Accounting

*AgroFresh (NYSE-listed) | São Paulo, Brazil | LATAM Region*Sep 2018 – May 2025

- Owned GL accounting, month-end closing process, and financial reporting for subsidiaries in Mexico, Chile, Argentina, Peru, and Brazil, adhering to IFRS, US GAAP, and local regulations.
- Implemented robust internal controls, coordinated internal and external audits, led tax planning and transfer pricing strategy across the region.
- Drove 3 M&A due diligence processes and post-acquisition integration of new LATAM subsidiaries, establishing statutory reporting and compliance frameworks from the ground up.
- Partnered with cross-functional teams including engineers and business partners to re-design and optimise financial processes, resulting in significant reduction of manual tasks.
- Developed management reporting, KPIs, and dashboards; managed regional cash flows and implemented transfer pricing policies across 5 countries.

Head of Accounting & IFRS Reporting LATAM

*Capgemini Brazil | São Paulo, Brazil*Apr 2017 – Sep 2018

- Managed Brazilian monthly GL close (BR GAAP) and consolidated statements for a multinational group; produced IFRS reporting packages and FP&A analyses for headquarters.
- Led M&A initiatives, transfer pricing studies, and impairment reviews; developed financial models and internal accounting policies across Latin America.
- Supervised a team of 11 analysts and deployed automation via SAP, Power BI, and automated reporting systems to enhance accuracy and efficiency.
- Reviewed taxes (IRPJ/CSLL, PIS, COFINS); managed internal and external audits and prepared financial statements and explanatory notes.

Early Career

Accounting Coordinator, Assessor Bordin Business Consultants (2017–2018) | Accounting Analyst, Watanabe Assessoria Contábil (2015–2017) | Tax & Accounting Analyst, Lune Business Advisory / Bookeepers Tax Consulting (2014–2015)

EDUCATION

MBA in Corporate Finance – Fundação Getulio Vargas (FGV)Expected Jun 2027
Bachelor in Accounting – Anhembi Morumbi University2018
Bachelor in Law – Unifieo University Center2006

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

- ACCA Certificate in International Financial Reporting (Cert IFR) | IFRS Advanced Certificate
- Financial Modelling & Valuation Analyst (FMVA®) | Certified Data Modelling in Power BI
- Organisational Leadership Certificate – Harvard Business School Online
- Certified Accountant – CRC/SP (Active) | EF SET English C2 Certificate
- Member of IBEF (Instituto Brasileiro de Executivos de Finanças) and Power Tax Brasil

TECHNICAL SKILLS & TOOLS

GL Accounting & Compliance: GL Accounting, Month-End Close, Financial Close & Consolidation, Statutory Reporting, IFRS, US GAAP, BR GAAP, Internal Controls, Audit Management, Tax Planning, Transfer Pricing, CPC/CVM Regulations, Financial Services Compliance

Planning & Analysis: FP&A, Budgeting & Forecasting, Cost Accounting, Variance Analysis, Financial Modelling, M&A Due Diligence & Integration, Process Improvement & Optimisation

Systems & Tools: SAP (primary ERP), Oracle (working knowledge), Power BI, Power Automate, BFC, ClickUp, Microsoft 365, AI Tools (Microsoft GPT)

Languages: Portuguese (Native) | English (C2 – Fluent) | Spanish (C1 – Advanced)